# Brainstorming a semester-long course progression

PROMPT

Act as an instructional designer specialising in language teaching in blended environments (synchronous and asynchronous). You are well versed in theories of intrinsic motivation (Deci & Ryan, self-determination theory), the principles of second language acquisition (SLA), the neuroscience of learning, and active and game-based teaching approaches that have a concrete impact in the professional world. Your goal: to create a complete, coherent and pragmatic course architecture for a semester-long course.

I would like to design a course on the theme of [THEME]. Give me 7 options for immersive scenarios that foster intrinsic motivation (justify your proposals) before generating the rest. Ask me questions before submitting scenarios if you are missing any information.

**INSTITUTIONAL CONTEXT AND TARGET AUDIENCE**

Institutional setting: [EXAMPLE: French university, languages for students of other disciplines (LANSAD), semester 1 of a first-year History degree]

Students' level: [EXAMPLE: CEFR A2+]

Number of students: [EXAMPLE: 30]

Group heterogeneity: [EXAMPLE: Very mixed: some have already lived in immersion (C1), others have never spoken the language (A1)]

Motivational profile: [EXAMPLE: Mainly extrinsic motivation (attendance at LANSAD classes is compulsory). Little emotional connection with the language.]

Technological context: [EXAMPLE: All have access to a computer and the internet. Minimal Moodle skills (compulsory institutional platform)]

**THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK**

[EXAMPLE: Self-determination theory (Deci & Ryan). Priorities: student autonomy + progressive competence + minimal but genuine social connection. Task-based approach (Ellis, CEFR). Priority on spoken production. Active learning (role play, debate, problem solving). No purely lecture-based teaching. Game-based learning (using game mechanics to create a state of flow, as distinct from gamification)]

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES (COMPETENCY-BASED APPROACH)**

Write 3 to 5 clear, measurable learning objectives following Bloom/Anderson.

Recommended format: By the end of the semester, students will be able to… [ACTION VERB + CONTENT + CONTEXT]

Objective 1: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to take part in a group conversation on a current-affairs topic, sustaining the interaction for at least 10

minutes, using expressions of concession and markers of disagreement.]

Objective 2: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to write an argumentative text (short essay) in English, at B1 level, on a STEM-related topic.]

Objective 3: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to understand and summarise a 5–10 minute podcast or video in English with at least 80% comprehension.]

**FORMAT, CONSTRAINTS AND ASSESSMENT**

Total teaching hours: [EXAMPLE: 18 contact hours + unlimited asynchronous work]

Number of weeks: [EXAMPLE: 12 weeks (January–May)]

Synchronous/asynchronous rhythm: [EXAMPLE: Bisynchronous: 1.5 hours by video call per week (Wednesday 2 pm) + 2–3 hours of asynchronous work per week. Pedagogical rationale: synchronous interaction for speaking (real-time feedback needed), asynchronous for writing (reflection + revision).]

Available resources: [EXAMPLE: Moodle, Zoom, Genially licence, free tools.]

Assessment format: [EXAMPLE: Continuous assessment based on a portfolio + synchronous role plays + asynchronous assignments]

Assessment frequency and milestones: [EXAMPLE: 4 formal assessment milestones (weeks 3, 6, 9, 12) + informal weekly feedback. No final exam. 40% synchronous assessment (speaking), 60% asynchronous (writing + video production).]

Assessment weighting: [EXAMPLE: Synchronous participation 20% + Written portfolio 30% + Individual oral project 25% + Reflective self-assessment 25%]

**ROLE OF AI IN THE COURSE**

Student support: [EXAMPLE: An asynchronous AI tutor (e.g. a chatbot on Moodle) to answer factual questions. No personalised feedback on written work (given by the teacher).]

**EXPECTED DELIVERABLES**

Complete course architecture: overall scenario, weekly plan (objectives per week + synchronous activities + asynchronous activities)

Content modules: [NUMBER] detailed modules

Learning activities: at least [NUMBER] activities per week, including synchronous and asynchronous interaction

Teacher resources: facilitation guides, Zoom scripts, time management

Assessment tools: grids, rubrics, marking schemes

**VALIDATION CRITERIA**

Pedagogical coherence: [EXAMPLE: Every activity must serve the objectives. Activities must genuinely get students speaking/writing. No “filler”. Every interaction must count.]

Adaptability to mixed levels: [EXAMPLE: A2+ and B2 levels in the same class → offer difficulty variants for each activity.]

Assessment frequency in line with workload: [EXAMPLE: No assessment every week (otherwise students are paralysed by the workload).]

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